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General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

Sports Awards in India

Sports Awards in India

Sports awards are a way of recognizing and celebrating the remarkable achievements, dedication, and contributions of sportspersons and coaches. These awards serve to honour excellence in sports performance, coaching, and lifetime contributions to the development of sports in a country.

The key national sports awards in India include:

- Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award: The highest sporting honour for exceptional sports performance.
- Arjuna Award: For consistently outstanding performance and sportsmanship.
- Dronacharya Award: To recognize the excellence of coaches in sports.
- Dhyan Chand Award: For lifetime contributions to the development of sports.

These awards not only bring prestige to the recipients but also reflect the country's commitment to fostering a robust sporting ecosystem.

Award	Purpose	Eligibility	Benefits
Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award	For outstanding performance in sports over 4 years.	Recognizes excellence in sports performance.	₹7.5 lakhs cash prize, a citation, and a medal.
Arjuna Award	For consistently outstanding performance over 4 years in sports, leadership, and sportsmanship.	Sportspersons with significant contributions in sports.	₹5 lakhs cash prize, a certificate, and a statuette.
Dronacharya Award	To honour excellence in coaching in sports.	Coaches producing medal winners in prestigious events.	₹5 lakhs cash prize, a certificate, and a statuette.

Dhyan Chand Award	For lifetime contribution to sports development in India.	Individuals contributing as coaches to Indian sports.	₹5 lakhs cash prize, a certificate, and a statuette.

Winners of the Major Dhyanchand Khel Ratna Award

Year	Name	Category
1991-92	Viswanathan Anand	Chess
1992-93	Geet Sethi	Billiards
1993-94	Cdr. Homi D. Motivala	Yachting
	Pushpendra Kumar Garg	
1994-95	Karnam Malleswari	Weightlifting
1995-96	Nameirakpam Kunjarani	Weightlifting
	Leander Paes	Tennis
1996-97	Sachin Tendulkar	Cricket
1997-98	Jyotirmoyee Sikdar	Athletics
1998- 1999	Dhanraj Pillay	Hockey
1999-2000	Pullela Gopichand	Badminton
2000-01	Abhinav Bindra	Shooting
2001-02	Anjali Ved Pathak Bhagwat	Shooting
	K. M. Beenamo	Athletics
2003	Anju Bobby George	Athletics
2004	Lt. co. Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore	Shooting
2005	Pankaj Advani	Billiards & Snooker
2006	Manavjit Singh Sandhu	Shooting
2007	Mahendra Singh Dhoni	Cricket

2009	Mary Kom	Boxing
	Vijender Singh	Boxing
	Sushil Kumar	Wrestling
2010	Saina Nehwal	Badminton
2011	Gagan Narang	Shooting
2012	Vijay Kumar	Shooting
	Yogeshwar Dutt	Wrestling
2013	Ronjan Sodhi	Shooting
2015	Sania Mirza	Tennis
2016	P. V. Sindhu	Badminton
	Sakshi Malik	Wrestling
	Dipa Karmakar	Gymnastics
	Jitu Rai	Shooting
2017	Devendra Jhajharia	Para Athlete
	Sardara Singh	Hockey
2018	Virat Kohli	Cricket
	Mirabai Chanu	Weightlifting
2019	Bajrang Punia	Wrestling
	Deepa Malik	Athletics
2020	Rohit Sharma	Cricket
	Mariyappan Thangavelu	Paralympic high jump
	Manika Batra	Table tennis
	Vinesh Phogat	Freestyle wrestling
	Rani Rampal	Hockey
2021	Neeraj Chopra	Athletics
	Ravi Kumar Dahiya	Freestyle wrestling

	Lovlina Borgohain	Boxing
	P. R. Sreejesh	Hockey
	Avani Lekhara	Paralympic shooting
	Sumit Antil	Para-athletics
	Pramod Bhagat	Para-badminton
	Krishna Nagar	Para-badminton
	Manish Narwal	Paralympic shooting
	Mithali Raj	Cricket
	Sunil Chhetri	Football
	Manpreet Singh	Hockey
2022-2023	Sharath Kamal	Table tennis

Winners of the Arjuna Award

Name	**Discipline**	**Sports**
2023	Jerlin Anika Jayaratchagan	Badminton
2016	Virender Singh	Wrestling
2006	Rohit Bhaker	Badminton
1999	Ranjini Ramanujam	Badminton
1996	Sandeep Dillon	Badminton
1991	Rajeev Bagga	Badminton
1986	Taranath Shenoy	Swimming
1977-78	Satish Kumar	Athletics
1974	Ajan Bhattacharjee	Cricket

Do You Know?

- In 1981, Krishna Das was the first winner in Archey.
- Meena Shah was the first woman to receive a Badminton award in 1962.
- Amar Singh was the first award for the Arjuna Award in 1975 for cycling.

Winners of the Dronacharya Awards

- O M Nambiar, Om Prakash Bharadwaj, and B B Bhagwat were the first to receive this award.
- The first awardee for chess in this category was Raghunandan V Gokhle in 1986.
- Hansa Sharma was the first woman to receive this award for weightlifting in 2000

Year	Recipient	Sports
1985	Bhalachandra Bhaskar Bhagwat	Wrestling
1985	Om Prakash Bhardwaj	Boxer
1985	O. M. Nambiar	Athletics
1986	Desh Prem Azad	Cricket
1986	Raghunandan Vasant Gokhale	Chess
1987	Guru Hanuman	Wrestling
1987	Gurcharan Singh	Cricket
1990	Ramakant Achrekar	Cricket
1990	Syed Naimuddin	Football
1990	A. Ramana Rao	Volleyball
1994	Ilyas Babar	Athlete

1995	Shyam Sundar Rao	Volleyball
1995	Karan Singh	Athlete
1996	Wilson Jones	Billiard and Snooker
1996	Pal Singh Sandhu	Weight Lifting
1997	Joginder Singh Saini	Athlete
1998	G.S.Sandhu	Boxing
1998	Hargobind Singh Sandhu	Athlete
2023	Mahavir Prasad Saini	Para Athletics
2023	Lalit Kumar	Wrestling
2023	R.B. Ramesh	Chess
2023	Shivendra Singh	Hockey
2023	Jaskirat Singh Grewal	Golf (Lifetime)
2023	Bhaskaran E	Kabaddi (Lifetime)
2023	Jayanta Kumar Pushilal	Table Tennis (Lifetime)

Winners of the Dyanchand Award

Year	**Recipient(s)**	**Discipline(s)**
2002	Shahuraj Birajdar	Boxing
	Ashok Diwan	Hockey
	Aparna Ghosh	Basketball
2003	Charles Cornelius	Hockey
	Ram Kumar	Basketball
	Dharam Singh	Hockey
	Om Prakash	Volleyball
	Smita Shirole Yadav	Rowing
2004	Digamber Mehendale	Athletics (Physically challenged)

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	Hardayal Singh	Hockey
	Labh Singh	Athletics
2005	Maruti Mane	Wrestling
	Manoj Kumar Kothari	Billiards & Snooker
	Rajinder Singh	Hockey
2006	Harishchandra Birajdar	Wrestling
	Uday K. Prabhu	Athletics
	Nandy Singh	Hockey
2007	Rajinder Singh	Wrestling
	Shamsher Singh	Kabaddi
	Varinder Singh	Hockey
2008	Gian Singh	Wrestling
	Hakam Singh	Athletics
	Mukhbain Singh	Hockey
2009	Satbir Singh Dahiya	Wrestling
	Ishar Singh Deol	Athletics
2010	Anita Chanu	Weightlifting
	Satish Pillai	Athletics
	Kuldeep Singh	Wrestling
2011	Shabbir Ali	Football
	Sushil Kohli	Swimming
	Rajkumar Baisla	Wrestling
2012	Gundeep Kumar	Hockey
	Vinod Kumar	Wrestling
	Jagraj Singh Mann	Athletics
	Sukhbir Singh Tokas	Para-Sports

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2013	Syed Ali	Hockey
	Anil Mann	Wrestling
	Mary D'Souza Sequeira	Athletics
	Girraj Singh	Athletics (Parasports)
2014	Zeeshan Ali	Tennis
	Gurmail Singh	Hockey
	K. P. Thakkar	Swimming
2015	Romeo James	Hockey
	Shiv Prakash Mishra	Tennis
	T. P. Padmanabhan Nair	Volleyball
2016	Sylvanus Dung Dung	Hockey
	Sathi Geetha	Athletics
	Rajendra Pralhad Shelke	Rowing
2017	Bhupender Singh	Athletics
	Syed Shahid Hakim	Football
	Sumrai Tete	Hockey
2018	Satyadev Prasad	Archery
	Bharat Chettri	Hockey
	Bobby Aloysius	Athletics
	Dadu Dattatray Chougale	Wrestling
2019	Manuel Frederick	Hockey
	Arup Basak	Table Tennis
	Manoj Kumar	Wrestling
	Nitin Kirtane	Tennis
	Chhangte Lalremsanga	Archery
2020	Kuldip Singh Bhullar	Athletics

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	Jincy Philips	Athletics
	Pradeep Shrikrishna Gandhe	Badminton
	Trupti Murgunde	Badminton
	Usha Nagisetty	Boxing
	Lakha Singh	Boxing
	Sukhvinder Singh Sandhu	Football
	Ajit Pal Singh	Hockey
	Manpreet Singh	Kabaddi
	Ranjith Kumar Jayaseelan	Para Athletics
	Satyaprakash Tiwari	Para Badminton
	Manjeet Singh	Rowing
	Sachin Nag	Swimming
	Nandan Bal	Tennis
	Netarpal Hooda	Wrestling
2021	Lekha K.C.	Boxing
	Abhijit Kunte	Chess
	Davinder Singh	Hockey
	Vikas Kumar	Kabaddi
	Sajan Singh	Wrestling
2022	Ashwini Akkunji	Athletics
	Dharamvir Singh	Hockey
	B.C. Suresh	Kabaddi
	Nir Bahadur Gurung	Para Athletics
2023	Manjusha Kanwar	Badminton
	Vineet Kumar Sharma	Hockey
	Kavitha Selvaraj	Kabaddi

Other Important Sports Award

Sports	Facts
Maulana Abul Kalam Azad (MAKA) Trophy	• Given to the winner of the annual women's national basketball championship held by the Basketball Federation of India since 1963.
Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award	• Honours the Indian expedition teams/individuals who display exceptional courage, enterprise, perseverance and spirit of adventure in the field of land, sea and air.
Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puruskar	• This award recognizes the efforts of corporations, voluntary organizations, and sports boards in promoting sports over the past three years. • Since its inception in 2009, it has been awarded in four categories: identification and nurturing of talent, encouragement of sports through corporate social responsibility, employment of sportspersons and sports welfare, and sports promotion through development. • Each winner receives a citation and a trophy. In 2021, Manav Rachna Educational Institutions received the award for their work in developing athletic talent.

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